

Figure 8.1. The Second International Congress for the Unity of Science in June 1936, at Niels Bohr's house in Copenhagen. Jørgen Jørgensen is standing, Niels Bohr is on the far right of the front row, and Philipp Frank is second from right in the front. Karl Popper is immediately to the left of Jørgensen. Otto Neurath is third from the left in the fourth row and Carl Hempel is seated immediately behind Neurath. The empty chairs in front are likely for Schlick, Carnap, and Reichenbach, all of whom wanted to attend and none of whom were able to do so.

The positivists and the founders of quantum physics didn't just share common sources of inspiration—they also had direct contact with one another, discussing common interests in science and philosophy. Neurath visited Copenhagen a few times, meeting Bohr in 1934, and afterward corresponded with Bohr for several years. Writing to Carnap after first meeting Bohr, Neurath said that Bohr "possesses certain basic attitudes which agree with mine." Writing to Neurath later, Bohr expressed his pleasure that their views were not too far apart. In the summer of 1936, Neurath and Bohr teamed up with Jørgen Jørgensen, a Danish positivist, to organize the Second International Congress for the Unity of Science. The conference, naturally, was in Copenhagen—in fact, it was held in Niels Bohr's house, the Carlsberg House of Honor (Figure 8.1). At that conference, Frank presented a paper on behalf of Schlick, titled "Quantum Theory and the Knowability of Nature." Schlick's paper argued that "in physics it is meaningless to speak about factors which are unknowable in